FREE GUIDE · STUDIO VALENTINA

Before You Build *in Georgia.*

A step-by-step checklist for planning your custom home, from the lot to move-in day.



1. LAND & LOT

- [ ] Confirm zoning and allowed use with the city or county planning office
- [ ] Order a boundary survey and check setbacks, easements and flood zone (FEMA map)
- [ ] Ask about HOA covenants or architectural review requirements
- [ ] No sewer? Schedule a soil / percolation test for a septic permit
- [ ] Verify access to water, power, gas and internet at the street

2. BUDGET & FINANCING

- [ ] Get a construction loan pre-approval before finalizing the design
- [ ] Budget for soft costs: design, engineering, permits, impact fees, surveys
- [ ] Keep a contingency of at least 10% of construction cost
- [ ] Price your finishes early (flooring, cabinets, fixtures) to avoid surprises

3. DESIGN

- [ ] Write a wish list: rooms, lifestyle, storage, future needs
- [ ] Orient the house for sun, views and privacy before fixing the layout
- [ ] Approve floor plans, elevations and a finish schedule in writing
- [ ] Ask if your jurisdiction needs engineered or stamped drawings

4. PERMITS & TEAM

- [ ] Hire a Georgia-licensed residential or general contractor
- [ ] Check the contractor's license, insurance and recent references
- [ ] Apply for the building permit with your local building department
- [ ] Confirm who handles inspections and when each one happens

5. CONTRACT & CONSTRUCTION

- [ ] Sign a written contract with scope, price, schedule and payment draws
- [ ] Agree on how change orders are priced and approved
- [ ] Confirm builder's risk insurance is in place
- [ ] Collect lien waivers from the builder and subs with each payment
- [ ] Walk the site at key stages: foundation, framing, pre-drywall

6. MOVE-IN

- [ ] Complete a final walkthrough and punch list
- [ ] Receive the certificate of occupancy before moving in
- [ ] Get warranties, manuals and as-built documents in one folder



Ready to design your home?

Studio Valentina designs custom homes in Georgia, in English or Spanish.
Book a free intro call or message us on WhatsApp: +1 (678) 490-5574

studio-valentina.com

General information only, not legal, financial or engineering advice. Requirements vary by city and county; confirm with your local building department.